Apex Systems

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Response to: Meridian Retail Group (MRG) — MRG-RFP-2026-014: Omnichannel Customer Support Platform
Submission date: 2026-10-10

1. Executive Summary

Apex Systems is pleased to respond to MRG-RFP-2026-014. We propose ApexDesk Enterprise, a cloud-native omnichannel support platform engineered for high-volume retail contact centres. Our design prioritises reliability during peak trading periods, deep integration with MRG's commerce and ERP landscape, and a security posture that meets the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023.

We understand that MRG needs to consolidate email, web chat, WhatsApp and voice interactions for 350 agents across three contact centres into a single agent workspace, with a unified customer view drawn from SAP S/4HANA and Shopify Plus, and with data held in India. Our proposal addresses each requirement with production-proven components rather than custom development.

2. Proposed Solution and Architecture

ApexDesk runs as a set of containerised microservices on Kubernetes in the AWS Mumbai region (ap-south-1), with a warm standby in AWS Hyderabad (ap-south-2) for disaster recovery. All channels feed a common event bus (Apache Kafka), which keeps channels decoupled and lets the platform scale each service independently.

- Pre-built, certified connectors for SAP S/4HANA (OData v4 order, return and invoice APIs) and Shopify Plus (Admin GraphQL API and webhooks) give agents live order status inside the ticket view.
- Genesys Cloud CTI integration for voice: screen-pop, click-to-dial and call recordings linked to tickets.
- WhatsApp Business Platform integration through Meta's Cloud API with template management.
- Open REST and GraphQL APIs with an API gateway, rate limiting and versioning for future integrations.
- Load tested to 5,000 concurrent agent sessions and 1,200 messages per second; target availability SLA of 99.95% per month.
- AI-assisted routing, suggested replies and knowledge-base recommendations (can be switched off per queue).

Data residency: all customer personal data, attachments, backups and logs are stored in India. No personal data leaves Indian regions, including for AI features, which use models hosted in ap-south-1.

3. Implementation Approach, Timeline and Team

We follow a four-phase delivery approach with a fixed scope baseline agreed at the end of Discovery. Total duration is 24 weeks from contract signature to go-live, followed by 4 weeks of hypercare.

Phase	Weeks	Key milestones
Discovery & design	1-4	Solution design sign-off; integration specifications
Build & integrate	5-14	SAP and Shopify connectors live in test; channel set-up
Test & migrate	15-20	SIT, performance test, UAT sign-off; ticket history migration
Rollout	21-24	Pilot centre (Pune) week 21; all three centres live week 24

Team: engagement director (part-time), project manager, solution architect, 2 integration engineers, 2 platform engineers, QA lead, change and training lead. Implementation risks such as SAP API availability and data migration quality are tracked in a weekly risk log reviewed with MRG.

4. Commercial Proposal

Pricing is in Indian Rupees, exclusive of GST, for a three-year term.

Item	Basis	Amount (INR)
Implementation services (fixed price)	One-time	1,10,00,000
ApexDesk subscription, 350 agent licences	INR 3,600 per agent per month	4,53,60,000
Premium support and 24x7 operations	Per year x 3	54,00,000
Total three-year cost of ownership		6,17,60,000

Assumptions: MRG provides SAP and Shopify sandbox access by week 3; up to 2 million historical tickets are migrated; licence price is fixed for three years; payment milestones are 20% at signature, 40% at UAT sign-off and 40% at go-live for the implementation fee.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

- Certifications: ISO/IEC 27001:2022 and ISO/IEC 27701 certified; SOC 2 Type II report (latest period ending June 2026) available under NDA.
- Encryption: AES-256 at rest with customer-managed keys in AWS KMS; TLS 1.3 in transit.
- Identity: SAML 2.0 / OIDC single sign-on with MRG's Azure AD, role-based access control, MFA enforced.
- Audit: immutable audit logs of every agent and administrator action, retained for 3 years and exportable to MRG's SIEM.
- Testing: annual third-party penetration test and quarterly vulnerability scans; findings shared with MRG.
- Privacy: DPDP Act consent capture, data principal requests (access, correction, erasure) and configurable retention policies are built in.
- Business continuity: RPO 15 minutes, RTO 4 hours, with twice-yearly DR drills.

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Support is provided 24x7 by our Bengaluru operations centre. P1 incidents receive a 30-minute response; P2 within 2 hours; P3 next business day. A named service manager provides monthly service reviews.

Relevant experience: six omnichannel contact-centre implementations in the last four years, including two for retailers with more than 200 agents.

- Northstar Fashion (retail, 280 agents) - ApexDesk with SAP integration, live since 2024.
- Kavya Home Stores (retail, 140 agents) - reference available on request.